STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	G-1600

	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED 07/21/20	DATE REVIEWED 2/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		

CHAPTER TITLE	RESOURCES
GENERAL	

SUBJECT	CROSS REFERENCE
NEPOTISM	

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines for the employment and duty assignment of immediate family members and those employees involved in a dating/consensual romantic and/or sexual relationship.

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office may employ more than one family member of an immediate family. When such circumstances occur the following procedures shall be followed. The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall not prevent employees from becoming involved in dating/consensual romantic and/or sexual relationships and, generally, shall not require employees so involved to notify the Sheriff's Office of the relationship, but employees so involved shall adhere to the following procedures.

III. Definitions:

A. IMMEDIATE FAMILY MEMBER: Members of the immediate family shall include: wife, husband, son, daughter, mother, father, brother, or sister.

B. DATING/CONSENSUAL ROMANTIC/SEXUAL RELATIONSHIP: Dating/consensual romantic and/or sexual relationship shall mean frequent, intimate associations primarily characterized by the expectation of affectional or sexual involvement, but does not include a casual relationship or an ordinary association between persons in a business or social context.

IV. Procedures:

A. Supervision of Family Members or those in a Dating/Consensual Romantic/Sexual Relationship: No employee shall be placed in a permanent position to directly supervise or be directly supervised by an immediate family member on a regular basis. No employee shall directly supervise, on a regular

basis, an individual with whom he or she has a dating/consensual romantic and/or sexual relationship. Those employees involved in a dating/consensual romantic and/or sexual relationships shall notify the Administrative Commander if duty assignments violate this policy.

B. **Shift Assignment:** The Sheriff shall reserve the right to determine if immediate family members and those individuals involved in a dating/consensual romantic and/or sexual relationship will be allowed to work on the same shift within the same division. The Sheriff's Office reserves the right to transfer one employee to the opposite shift (e.g. A shift to B shift) in order to maintain the integrity of this policy. In no event shall an employee's shift bid be compromised to enforce this policy. Those employees involved in a dating/consensual romantic and/or sexual relationship shall notify the Administrative Commander if they are assigned to the same shift.

C. **Support Unit Assignment:** The Sheriff shall reserve the right to determine if immediate family members and those individuals involved in a dating/consensual romantic and/or sexual relationship will be allowed to be assigned to the same support unit, whether the unit is a part-time (e.g. the Emergency Service Unit) or a full-time position (the Court Services Unit). Those employees involved in a dating/consensual romantic and/or sexual relationship shall notify the unit or division commander if they are assigned to the same support unit.

D. **Overtime/Temporary Assignment:** If a personnel shortage occurs, a shift supervisor has the authority to order additional personnel to duty. If this overtime/temporary assignment causes immediate family members or those involved in a dating/consensual romantic and/or sexual relationship to work on the same shift, all attempts shall be made to keep the subordinate employee under the direct supervision of an alternate supervisor (this may require an exchange of employees between divisions, e.g. jail to road). At no time shall the supervisor of an immediate family member or a supervisor who is involved in a dating/consensual romantic and/or sexual relationship with an employee be allowed to submit a performance evaluation or complete a findings report on that family member or individual involved in that dating/consensual romantic and/or sexual relationship.